

## Project Proposal - Gather

Our proposal, Gather, is a website focused on helping college students manage assignments that are scattered across different platforms and make it neat and clear when and what is due. As students, we often have due dates posted on Brightspace, professor websites, syllabi, PDFs, and other course resources, making it easy to miss assignments due to how much we have to remember to check. Gather will solve this problem by automatically collecting this information, organizing it into one place, and updating it as needed.

The main feature of Gather is its ability to import tasks from multiple sources without having to manually parse large sets or upkeep. With permission from LMU's Brightspace administration, whom we will have to meet with to see if possible, users will be able to authorize Gather to access their Brightspace account. Gather will collect the user's assignments and allow them to choose what they want to import, and collect assignment details and attachments; this includes assignments that are posted as an announcement or content. Students will also be able to provide URLs or PDFs, such as syllabi and professor websites. The application will extract and clean the relevant text before sending it to an LLM, which will identify due dates and convert them into a consistent assignment format.

Our planned technology stack includes ReactJS for the frontend, Node.js/Express for the backend, and Firebase for storing all the user data. The LLM will return structured due-date information that can then be saved in Firebase. Since AI or the Brightspace API could occasionally be unreliable, Gather will include a review and confirmation page where users approve assignments before they are created. Duplicate and unnecessary assignments can also be identified and rejected.

Unlike tools such as Google Calendar, My Study Life, or Brightspace, which aren't automatic and require frequent updates every time something is uploaded, Gather focuses on automatically getting assignment information across different websites and documents and combining it into one manageable and live to-do list.